

# WHAT YOU NEED TO DO

## Evaluate Entrepreneurial Ideas



Evaluating the idea:



Do I believe the idea genuinely feasible?



Is this a new idea (given my target market)?



Can I make a profit by implementing the idea - even in the long term?



Ask others what they think about your idea and how they would rate it?



Try it out for real and obtain live feedback!



# EVALUATING A NEW IDEA : EXPERIMENTING WITHOUT INVESTING TOO MANY RESOURCES

- Try things out because you won't know in advance if an idea will work
- Don't use too many resources in the experiment - remember it might not work
- You'll have a better understanding if something works after you have tried it. Don't rely on your instinct alone
- Sometimes things that go wrong lead to new ideas e.g. marketing a product or adding an extra service. Things that don't work out are often experiments in disguise

# EVALUATING A NEW IDEA : EXPERIMENTING WITHOUT INVESTING TOO MANY RESOURCES



## Example:

Esther sells women's fashions. Lots of her customers bring their children with them when they shop.

She thinks it would be a good idea to sell clothes for children too.

So Esther makes 7 children's outfits and tries to sell them in her shop.



WS13



## EXERCISE :

# Experiment to identify the weak spots as well as the potential!

Denise overhears friends complaining about the price of cosmetics. She's also aware many imported products contain lots of chemical additives. Denise thinks that starting a range of organic cosmetics adapted for the skin of Kenyan women could be a good idea. Now she wants to find out if her idea has potential.

INSTRUCTION: Work **in pairs (02)**.

How can Denise test her idea?

Create an experiment to see if the idea is promising or not. Answer the following questions:

- What problems might happen during the experiment?
- What might Esther learn from these problems?





# EXERCISE: "Feedback from others"



Instruction:

We need one person to present their best business idea and two people to give feedback.

Instructions for the person presenting the idea:

- Present your business idea in three minutes and try to convince everyone about its merits.
- Two nominated people will respond.





# EXERCISE: Feedback from others



Instruction for the feedback person 1:

- Listen to the presentation and evaluate the business idea.  
Answer the following questions:
  - Is the idea original?
  - Is the idea profitable?
  - What is the biggest obstacle in realising the idea?

Instruction for the feedback person 2:

- Listen to the presentation and evaluate the business idea.  
After that, wait outside and make sure you cannot hear the feedback from feedback person 1.
- Then come back and answer the following questions:
  - Is the idea original?
  - Is the idea profitable?
  - What is the biggest obstacle in realising the idea?



In my  
opinion...

1

The  
idea is...

2



# EXERCISE: Feedback from others

Instruction for group:

- Watch the presentation and the evaluations of the two people giving feedback.
- After that, answer the following questions in a group discussion:
  - Which feedback elements are the same?
  - What are the differences between the two feedbacks?
  - What have you learnt from this exercise?



Review the self-assessment questionnaire "Innovation and opportunity identification".

Mark the points where you want to improve.





Identifying  
opportunities

Planning



Setting a  
goal

Seeking  
feedback

SET A GOAL





# SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONNAIRE

## setting a goal

Take the 'set a goal' self-assessment questionnaire and tick off what suits you.



# WHAT YOU NEED TO DO

## Set a SMART-PI goal:



Set yourself a goal ...



Specific (exact description of what you want to achieve)



Measurable (exact number, percentage, ...)



Ambitious, but



Realistic



Time-bound (exact date by which the objective must be achieved)

PI

Future-oriented :



Set goalsto cover different time periods, including long-term goals (1-2 years)

Overcoming-Barriers :



Protect your goal when barriers arise – don't sacrifice it in the face of a barrier